

User Guide: Farmer

This guide explains how to use the platform as a **Farmer**: posting produce, managing orders, booking pickups, responding to buyer requests, ordering inputs, and viewing analytics.

1. Logging in

- 1. Open the platform in your browser and go to **Login**.
- 2. Enter your **phone** (or email) and **password**. Use the **eye icon** next to the password field to show or hide your password as you type.
- 3. Click **Sign in**. You are taken to **My Orders** where you can see and manage your orders.

Note: Registration is currently disabled ("Coming Soon"). Your account is created by a staff admin from the **Users** page, or via bulk CSV upload by staff.

2. Main menu and navigation

After login, the sidebar shows:

Menu item	Path / Purpose
Buyer Requests	View buyer demand (RFQs and sourcing requests) and respond with offers
Inputs	Browse and order farm inputs (seeds, etc.)
My Produce	Post and manage your produce listings
Pickup Schedules	View and book pickup slots at aggregation centres
Orders	List and manage orders from buyers
Analytics	View your sales and activity metrics

Use the **menu icon** on small screens to open or close the sidebar.

In the header, you have two separate buttons: **Settings** (opens your profile page) and **Sign Out** (with a confirmation dialog before signing out).

3. Posting produce (My Produce)

Essence: This is how you **offer your produce to buyers** on the platform. By creating a listing, you make your crop visible to buyers so they can place orders. Approval by a lead farmer keeps quality and details consistent, and once approved your listing can receive orders straight away—including **advance orders** before the ready date.

Flow: Create listing → Pending approval → Approved (**ACTIVE**) or Revision requested.

1. Go to **My Produce** (sidebar).
2. You see tabs: **All Produce**, **Produce Listings**, and **Picked Up**. Summary cards show your total produce, total quantity, batches with batch IDs, and average price.
3. Click **Post produce** (or **Add listing**).
4. Fill in:
 - **Product type** (optional — from the commodity catalogue, e.g. Fresh Roots)
 - **Variety** (required — e.g. Kenya, SPK004, Kabode, from the catalogue)
 - **Quantity** and unit (default: kg)
 - **Quality grade** (required — A, B, or C, from the catalogue)
 - **Harvest date** (required — when the produce was or will be harvested)
 - **Price per kg** (required — in KES)
 - **County** (required — auto-filled from your profile)
 - **Aggregation centre** (required — searchable dropdown; auto-filled if you are assigned to one)
 - Optional: **Sub-county**, **ward**, **village** (read-only from your profile), **description**, **photos**
5. Submit. The listing is created with status **Pending lead approval**. You can also view the **On-Farm Sorting Guide** dialog for quality guidance.
6. A **lead farmer** (or staff) will approve or request changes. You get a notification.
7. If **approved**, the listing becomes **ACTIVE** and appears on the buyer marketplace (including for advance orders).
8. If **revision requested**, open the listing, fix the details, and resubmit for approval.

You can **edit** or **delete** your own listings from **My Produce** according to status rules. Use **filters** (search by variety/batch ID/location, variety, status) to find specific listings.

4. Managing orders from buyers (Orders)

Essence: Here you **see and manage every order** placed on your listings. You decide which orders to accept or reject, track payment and fulfilment, and follow the order through to collection or delivery.

Flow: Buyer places order → You see it under **Orders** → **Accept/Reject** → Order moves through payment and fulfilment.

1. Go to **Orders** in the sidebar.
2. You see all orders for **your** listings (any status: placed, accepted, paid, ready for collection, delivered, etc.).
3. For new orders (**Order placed**):
 - Open an order to see buyer, quantity, price, and delivery/collection details.
 - **Accept** or **Reject** the order. If you reject, you can add a reason.
4. After you accept:
 - Buyer may pay (escrow). When produce is ready, you (or the centre) update status (e.g. **Ready for collection**).
 - Buyer (or transport) collects or receives delivery; status moves to **Collected / Delivered**.
5. Use **Filters** (e.g. by status) and **Search** to find specific orders.

Orders from **advance** listings (expected ready date in the future) appear here as soon as the buyer places the order; fulfilment happens when the produce is ready.

5. Pickup schedules (delivering to aggregation centres)

Essence: This is how you **schedule and record delivery** of your produce to an aggregation centre. By booking a slot, you get a clear time and place to bring your crop, avoid overcrowding, and get your delivery recorded.

Flow: View schedules → Book a slot → Deliver produce → Receipt.

1. Go to **Pickup Schedules** in the sidebar.
2. You see **schedules** for aggregation centres (dates and available slots).
3. Select a schedule and **book a pickup slot** (e.g. for delivering your produce to the centre).
4. On the day, deliver produce to the centre in your slot. The centre may record **stock in** and you may get a **receipt** (view or download from the same area).

5. You can view past **pickup bookings** and receipts from this section.

6. Buyer requests (RFQs and sourcing requests)

Essence: This screen shows **buyer demand** — both **RFQs** (Requests for Quotation) and **Sourcing Requests** from buyers. You can respond with quotes or offers to secure sales. Use it to gauge demand, see what buyers are looking for, and compete for orders.

Flow: **Browse requests** → **View details** → **Submit quote (RFQ) or offer (sourcing request)**.

1. Go to **Buyer Requests** in the sidebar.
2. You see a list of buyer requests as cards, showing: title, buyer name, location, quantity, price range, deadline, number of responses, and status badge.
3. Use **filters** to narrow results:
 - **Search** by title, buyer name, or location
 - **Request type:** All, RFQs, or Sourcing
 - **Product type** (from the commodity catalogue)
 - **Status:** All, Active, Urgent, Evaluating, Awarded, Closed
 - **Sort by:** Newest, Oldest, Deadline soonest, Largest quantity
4. Click a request to **View Details**:
 - For **RFQs**: click **Submit Quote** to respond with your price and terms (available while status is "published" and before the deadline)
 - For **Sourcing Requests**: click **Submit Offer** to respond with your offer (available while status is "open" or "urgent")
5. Track your submitted responses and any awards from this section.

7. Inputs (farm inputs)

Essence: This is the **inputs marketplace** where you **order seeds and other farm inputs** from registered input providers. You can compare products and prices, place orders, and track them in one place.

1. Go to **Inputs** in the sidebar.
2. Browse **inputs** (e.g. seeds, fertiliser) offered by **input providers**.
3. Add items to cart and place an **order**.

4. Track your **input orders** from the same area or the link provided after ordering.

8. Analytics

Essence: Analytics gives you a **clear picture of your sales and activity**: how much you've sold, which varieties and grades perform best, and how your listings and orders behave over time.

1. Go to **Analytics** in the sidebar.
2. View summaries of your **sales, orders, listings, and activity** (e.g. over time, by variety or grade).
3. Use filters (e.g. date range) if available to focus on a period.

9. Notifications and profile

- **Notifications** (bell icon) show approvals, new orders, revision requests, and other updates. Open them to go to the relevant screen.
- Click **Settings** in the header to open your **Profile** page, where you can:
 - **Edit personal info**: first name, last name, county, sub-county, ward, village, address, alternate phone, bio
 - **Change phone or email**: requires **OTP verification** — enter the new value, receive a verification code, enter the code to confirm the change
 - **Update payment details**: M-PESA number, bank name and account number (for receiving payments)
 - **Update password**
- Click **Sign Out** in the header to log out. A **confirmation dialog** will ask you to confirm before signing out.

10. Quick reference: key flows

Goal	Steps
Sell produce	My Produce → Post produce → Fill variety, quantity, grade, harvest date, price, centre → Submit → Wait for approval → Orders appear when buyers order
Handle an order	Orders → Open order → Accept or Reject → Fulfil when ready (e.g. ready for collection)
Respond to buyer demand	Buyer Requests → Browse RFQs/Sourcing → View Details → Submit Quote or Submit Offer
Deliver to centre	Pickup Schedules → Book slot → Deliver on day → View receipt
Buy inputs	Inputs → Browse → Order → Track in input orders
See performance	Analytics → View metrics and charts
Update profile	Settings → Edit personal info, phone/email (with OTP), payment details

For **lead farmer** responsibilities (approving other farmers' listings), see [User Guide: Lead Farmer](#).